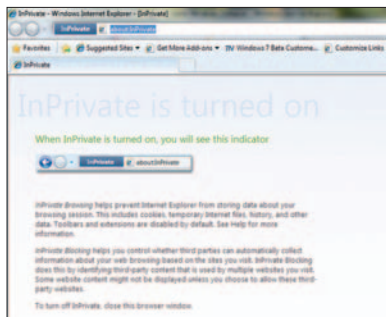


Feature



InPrivate and other features

InPrivate is akin to Chrome's Incognito mode. Start InPrivate browsing and IE8 will not retain your browsing history and cookies. IE8 offers InPrivate Browsing and InPrivate Filtering – either of which can be enabled independent of the other. InPrivate Browsing ensures that cookies, history and temporary internet files are not retained by the browser; toolbars and extensions are also automatically disabled while in this mode. InPrivate Filtering allows you to block online tracking behaviour of some web sites – basically behaviour that helps sites create and maintain an online profile of your online behaviour.



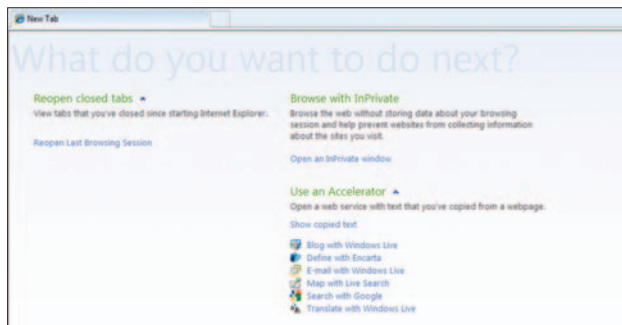
InPrivate Browsing prevents IE8 from storing cookies, history, and other data about your browsing session

IE8 also introduces a neat idea to tabbed browsing. Tabs that originate from the same parent page are colour-coded to indicate grouping. If you close a tab from a group, another tab from that group is displayed. You can also re-order tabs, while a right-click allows you to remove a tab from a group, close an entire group, close other tabs but the current one, ungroup tabs, and to even duplicate a tab.

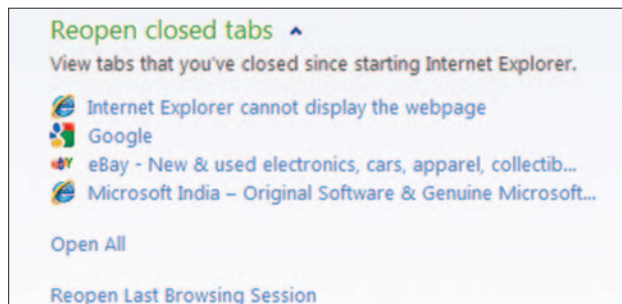
Another enhancement is the browser's Find on Page feature. Much like how Google Chrome handles it, pressing [Ctrl] + [F] reveals a small toolbar that shows you the number of matches for a particular keyword, along with letting you cycle through all instances of matched words. It's a much neater interface than IE's traditional pop-up style Find-on-Page box.

Crash recovery and security

If a tab crashes in IE8, it is automatically restored and reloaded. Moreover, information that you might have typed in the crashed tab – a mail or a form, perhaps – is also restored. IE8 isolates



Click on a New Tab button and IE8 offers common tasks including opening closed tabs and working on a closed browsing session



Reopen closed tabs from a New Tab window

Bugs

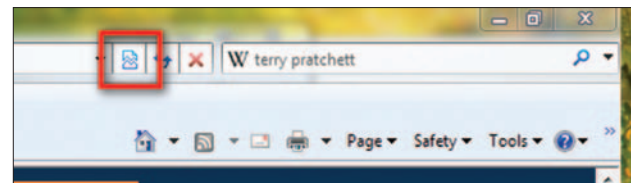
Don't expect a smooth run when you start surfing on IE8. It does not render more than 2000 top sites because the sites are not ready for it yet.

tabs, much like Chrome does, so that a crashed tab does not take the entire browser along with it.

IE8 also offers a phishing filter in the form of SmartScreen Filter. This is basically a black-list of known phishing sites; IE8 offers alerts when one accidentally stumbles upon such known offenders. ClickJacking, or prevention thereof, is another exploit that IE8 addresses. ClickJacking is essentially a malicious script that masquerades as something useful – a known URL, for example. Such scripts are typically embedded within well-hidden frames. IE8 allows a web site's programmer to add a tag to the header of the site. When tagged, IE8 notifies a user that the site's content is not meant to be inside of a frame and that the user might very well be the victim of ClickJacking.



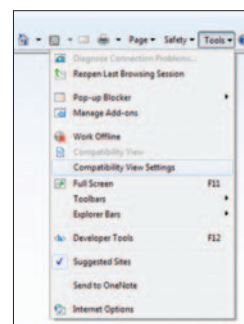
Compatibility View allows older websites to run on IE8. In this instance the How to BUY section does not work under native IE8



Click on the Compatibility Mode icon though...



...making the How to BUY area clickable



Manage Compatibility from the Tools menu

Enhanced compatibility

IE8 supports CSS 2.1, offers better AJAX and Javascript performance, and renders the Acid2 browser test correctly (it fails Acid3). It also ships with a more standards-compliant layout engine.

That concludes our tour of Internet Explorer 8, Release Candidate 1. If you are a user of either Firefox or Opera, you will find that Internet Explorer 8 offers little that is new and innovative. Almost everything that it brings to the table has been done before by its peers. It isn't the web browser re-imagined, but a leaner, faster, more compatible, more stable, more secure, and friendlier

Internet Explorer. IE8 isn't Microsoft leaping and bounding ahead of the competition; it's merely a dinosaur catching up. ■

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